ENGLISH I · WEEK 4

English I week 4 rules: Vocabulary and reading comprehension

Vocabulary: synonyms, antonyms, homophones · Reading comprehension & conversations. Save this PDF for revision.

VOCABULARY: SYNONYMS, ANTONYMS, HOMOPHONES · IN EVERY PAP

Homophones and confusables

Words	Meanings
week / weak	seven days / not strong: 'stay for a week' (PYQ)
wether / weather / whether	a castrated ram / climate / if: 'The wether was unsold in the auction' (PYQ)
too / to / two	excessively or also / towards / 2
course / coarse	a path or programme / rough
principal / principle	head, main / a rule
stationary / stationery	not moving / paper and pens

VOCABULARY: SYNONYMS, ANTONYMS, HOMOPHONES · IN EVERY PAP

Homophones and confusables

Words	Meanings
complement / compliment	completes / praise
accept / except	receive / excluding
loose / lose	not tight / misplace
desert / dessert	sandy land / sweet dish
its / it's	belonging to it / it is

VOCABULARY: SYNONYMS, ANTONYMS, HOMOPHONES · IN EVERY PAP

Words from past papers

Word	Answer
tenacity	antonym: timidity
yeoman	a farmer who owned and worked on his own land
archipelago	a collection of islands
order	antonym: chaos
surpassed	exceeded
touted	promoted
tanking	failing
debut	first appearance
prove · maladroit · tired · coach · coarse	establish · clumsy · wearied · counsel · gravelly

VOCABULARY: SYNONYMS, ANTONYMS, HOMOPHONES · IN EVERY PAP

Common traps

⚠ Tip: Synonym or antonym from a passage? Put each option into the sentence. The synonym keeps the meaning; the antonym flips it.

READING COMPREHENSION & CONVERSATIONS · IN EVERY PAPER

Strategy

- Read the questions first, then the passage, so you know what to look for.
- Answers are paraphrased: match the meaning, not the exact words.
- 'NOT TRUE' or 'EXCEPT': find each option in the passage; the one you can't find (or that contradicts it) is the answer.
- True/False: a single wrong detail (a name, number or place) makes the whole statement false.
- Use only the passage, never outside knowledge.

READING COMPREHENSION & CONVERSATIONS · IN EVERY PAPER

Conversation fill-ins: phrases that fit

Situation	Phrase
Answering a formal call	Good morning, XYZ Hospital. How may I help you?
Asking for someone	May I speak to Dr. …, please?
Asking the caller to wait	Could you please hold the line? / Please hold on a moment.
Taking a message	Would you like to leave a message? / May I know who's calling?

READING COMPREHENSION & CONVERSATIONS · IN EVERY PAPER

Conversation fill-ins: phrases that fit

Situation	Phrase
Booking	I'd like to book an appointment for…
Didn't catch it	Could you repeat that, please?
Closing	Thank you for calling. Have a nice day.
Informal reply	I'm doing great, thanks. How about you?

READING COMPREHENSION & CONVERSATIONS · IN EVERY PAPER

Common traps

⚠ Tip: For each blank, read the line after it. The reply tells you what the blank said: 'Sure, I'll hold' means the blank asked them to hold.

⚠ Match the register: hospital, office or professor ⇒ formal ('May I…', 'Could you please…'); siblings or friends ⇒ informal ('Hey', 'Cool').

Notes for every week of English I, free.

Full notes, the rule sheet and common traps, with worked PYQs.

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